

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major sit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

- 4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

- 3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

- 3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

- 3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

- 4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥6

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥2

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦9

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 4 2

♥ 10 2

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 10 8 7

♠ K Q J

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ 9 4

♣ J 6 5



♠ A 10 6 5

♥ 7 6

♦ K 8 7 5

♣ A 3 2

♠ 3

♥ A 9 5 3

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K Q 9 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♥6

SOUTH's 3♠ bid, a double-jump, is a Splinter bid. It shows game-forcing strength, at least four cards in partner's suit, and a singleton or void in the Splintered suit.

NORTH has just 14 points and the ♠ shortness in SOUTH's hand doesn't improve her hand since she had just one ♠ loser anyway. She signs off in 4♥.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ A 9 5 3
 ♦ A J 10 2
 ♣ K Q 9 4

♠ A Q J 5

♥ 10 7

♦ 9 6 5 3

♣ 8 7 3



♠ 7 6 4
 ♥ K Q J 8 4
 ♦ K 4
 ♣ A 6 5

♠ K 10 9 8 2

♥ 6 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ J 10 2

This is a companion hand to Deal 13.

EAST has 14 points, the same strength she had in Deal 13. But what a difference. This time WEST's ♠ shortness complements her hand very well. She bids 4♣ to show her Control, and after WEST shows the ♦ A she uses Blackwood to make sure WEST also has the trump Ace.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♥	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 6 4 3

♥ 5 3 2

♦ 9 2

♣ A 9 2

♠ K Q

♥ A K 8

♦ 7 5 4 3

♣ J 10 6 5



♠ J 9 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q 10 6

♣ 8 7 4

♠ A 7 5

♥ Q J 10 7 6

♦ J 8

♣ K Q 3

NORTH has 13 points and good 3-card support for SOUTH's 1♥ opening bid. But he should not bid 2NT since that bid promises 4+ cards in support. North must still insure they reach game, so he bids a forcing 2♣.

When SOUTH next says 2NT NORTH can jump to 4♥.

NOTE: if you used Jacoby 2NT and reached the 4♥ game, give yourself credit anyway.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦9			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ K J 9 6 5 2
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ K Q 5

♠ A 10 7 6 4

♥ Q

♦ 10 7 4 3

♣ 10 7 3



♠ K Q J
 ♥ A 8 7 3
 ♦ 6 2
 ♣ A J 9 2

♠ 9 8 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
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1 ♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
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3 ♠	Pass	4 ♣	Pass
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4NT	Pass	5 ♥	
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All Pass

5 ♥ by West

Lead: ♦ 4

WEST bids 3 ♠ to show a strong hand with a singleton ♠.

After EAST shows her first-round ♣ control WEST decides he will bid slam if EAST has three Aces.

When Blackwood reveals just two Aces in EAST, WEST stops at 5 ♥.